



Lucid's HYDRA 200 is a chip that lets any motherboard use ATI and NVIDIA GPUs together



Vue's surveillance system comes with two wireless cameras and a base station

photograph in low-light scenarios. The ability to set the aperture size and shutter speed is welcomed but there's very limited control over it.

The USB connector isn't the typical microUSB and the cable supplied with it allows you to connect it to a USB port on the desktop or also to a TV using composite connects.

Samsung ES55

The Samsung ES55 is a compact point and shoot with a nice brushed metal finish at the front but somewhat dull at the back. The controls buttons aren't of the same quality as the front. The OK button is so tiny that you have to use your fingernails at times to press it. The screen bulges out of the body otherwise it would've been a much more compact camera.

The user interface has a very high resolution and the fonts and menus are very impressive. When you go into the mode selection and camera settings, it's

even more apparent. It's one of the most comprehensive user interfaces of all the cameras we've seen. Every menu and setting has a description at the bottom of the screen.

Controls like these might impress those who are used to computers and gadgets in general with lots of complicated menus. Anyone buying a camera for the first time might not really like this overwhelming number of settings.

The preview and zooming function allows instant cropping and trimming of the photographs which is a neat little feature that can be found on some other cameras as well.

The camera also has a Photo Help guide feature which teaches users how to use the camera and its features. A simple listing of tasks is available with the steps to do the task. These tasks can also be used as a tutorial with step-by-step instructions.



Samsung ES55

The Roundup

We're impressed by the cameras that we received. To start with, the Samsung ES55 although a cheap camera at just Rs. 8,990, it performs rather well throughout the test. Even in last year's test, we had a Samsung with a really good lens. The



ES55 also matches that kind of performance for a fraction of the price. While all the cameras capture great detail on the wideangle range of the zoom, the Samsung ES55 does well even with the zoom lens fully utilised. The great thing is that it's also a compact camera, has a great looking interface. We give it the Best Buy award for these very reasons.

Canon has dominated most of the point-and-shoot cameras tests in the past. This time as well, the winner is a Canon. The Canon PowerShot SX200 IS is one of the costliest cameras of the lot. It's not a full-fledged ultrazoom camera either. It performs exceptionally well in both the features and in the performance tests. The camera shines in all the photo and video tests. If we were to rate the cameras on just quality, the SX200 IS would still be the winner. In terms

of specifications, it's got a very high-resolution sensor, a brilliant zoom lens and a very well designed body and controls. Even though this is just a digital camera, the ability to record videos at 1280 x 720 is a really nice thing to have. If the SX200 IS is out of

your budget, the SX120 should be the next in your list. It has a slightly cheaper feel but it still has a 10x zoom and all the manual controls that photographers crave for.

Another well performing camera was the Canon Digital IXUS 100 IS. Although a little older than the IXUS 110 IS, it is a very good performer for a really compact camera. It's not as pretty as the Canon Digital IXUS 110 IS but if you want pretty, the IXUS 110 IS is your next best option. It's only a tiny bit lower in performance than the IXUS 100 IS.

The Fujifilm FinePix S1500, the Nikon COOLPIX P90 and the Sony DSC-HX1 were the full-fledged ultrazooms that we got. We like the Sony DSC-HX1 but looking at the shots that we were able to take, it's nothing really special in terms of quality. It feels and functions like the other Sony cameras that we've tested in the past including some of the older H series ultrazoom cameras. The Nikon COOLPIX P90 had a nice set of features as well but no HD video recording functionality. If you want a really huge zoom lens, then the Nikon COOLPIX P90 is for you. **d**

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